

World in Brief: Trump says America and Iran are talking; wildfires in France and Spain



Photograph: Getty Images

Donald Trump said **America** was “having good talks” with **Iran**, but threatened to resume strikes if the negotiations failed. Mr Trump claimed that Iran had directly requested the talks, although Iran denied this. Fighting between the two countries has [paused for now](#), but on Monday Iran-backed militias in Iraq and Yemen attacked several of America’s Gulf allies, including Saudi Arabia, with drones.

Emmanuel Macron, **France’s** president, called an emergency cabinet meeting as **wildfires** spread to the suburbs of Bordeaux in the country’s south-west. More than 330,000 people have been asked to evacuate their homes across France and **Spain**, which has declared its first national emergency because of a wildfire. Forecasters expect [temperatures to rise](#) in the coming days, which may make it harder to fight the blazes.

Andy Burnham said his government would “honour every commitment” Britain had made to Ukraine in full, during a visit by **Volodymyr Zelensky**. Ukraine’s president was the first world leader to visit Mr Burnham [since he became prime minister](#) a week ago. Mr Burnham announced Britain would share technology for

countering drone jamming, and promised to help Ukraine achieve a “full and unconditional ceasefire” with Russia.

Amazon asked American regulators for permission to launch more than 5,000 **satellites** to provide mobile-phone services including voice calls and messaging. The firm hopes to compete with Elon Musk’s Starlink in the direct-to-device market, which provides services beyond the reach of cell towers. But it is much smaller than its rival, with fewer than 400 satellites in orbit; Starlink controls more than 10,000.

AstraZeneca, Britain’s [second-largest listed company](#), reported strong results for April to June. Profits for that period rose by 18% compared with a year before, beating analysts’ expectations. The drugmaker forecast that profits would continue to rise over the year. It also sought to reassure investors that an unexpectedly poor recent trial of Wainua, a heart-disease treatment, would not harm its long-term prospects.

Nvidia and other tech firms formed an alliance to share technical data (called “weights”) of AI models, and other technology, to improve **cybersecurity**. Such [“open-weight” models](#) can be customised, which Nvidia said can provide the flexibility needed to defend against attacks. Last week Hugging Face, an AI platform, suffered a cyberattack which it could not contain using leading “closed” models because of usage restrictions.

LVMH reported its first quarter of revenue growth in two years. The French luxury group benefited in particular from healthy demand in America, despite sluggishness in other markets, and the reinvigoration of its flagship brand Dior. Earlier Bernard Arnault, its billionaire boss, dismissed allegations that his five children, who run parts of the group, were squabbling over [succession](#).

Figure of the day: 8m, the number of barrels of oil that flowed through the Strait of Hormuz each day in early July. In recent days

that has fallen to 2m.

US in Brief: The Senate's busy week



Photograph: Getty Images

The **Senate** has a busy week ahead. John Thune, the majority leader, plans to introduce a short-term bill that will extend funding for federal agencies at current levels after the government's fiscal year ends on September 30th. That would give lawmakers more time to negotiate spending later in the year. Donald Trump wants the Senate to pass a \$95bn budget-reconciliation proposal: filibuster-proof legislation that provides additional funding for the Iran war, intelligence programmes, election security and farmers. But the majority leader is struggling to find enough votes. He will also try to advance an annual defence-policy bill, which Democrats opposed to [the Iran war](#) have blocked.

The **Pentagon** changed the way it reports casualties, making it harder for people to figure out how many people have been killed and wounded in the Iran war. Victims since July 7th are now listed on a separate webpage as “overseas-operations casualties”. The Pentagon also raised its account of the number of wounded since July 7th to 207; earlier it claimed that fewer than 100 troops had been injured in that time. Last week the Pentagon reduced from 18 to 14 the number of troops killed; the four missing casualties have now reappeared on the new webpage. Critics say the Pentagon is deliberately obscuring the toll taken by the war.

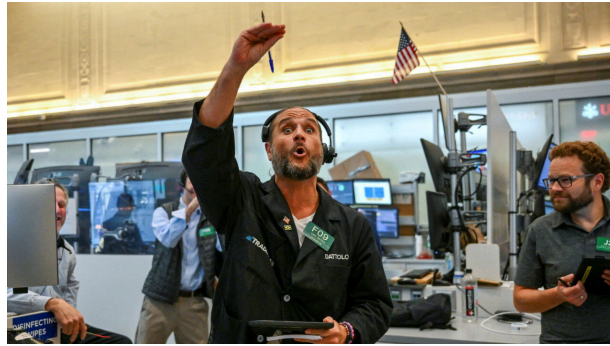
Democrats in **Maine** chose a new nominee for the must-win Senate race in November on Saturday. The previous candidate, [Graham Platner](#), dropped out following allegations of sexual assault, which he denies. Troy Jackson is a fifth-generation logger and former Maine Senate president. He will take on five-term Republican, Susan Collins. Democrats need a net gain of four seats for a Senate majority.

Three people were killed and four others wounded in a shooting at a downtown food festival in **Seattle**. One of the wounded was a toddler. Police detained one suspect and are searching for another; they believe the suspects were shooting at each other. Katie Wilson, the city's mayor, called it "an act of horrific violence".

At least 40m people in central and southern states faced **extreme-heat** warnings on Sunday thanks to [another "heat dome"](#). Energy providers are struggling to keep up with demand: the Energy Department gave Southwest Power Pool, a grid operator for 17 states, emergency authorisation to deploy more power sources in a bid to combat heatwave blackouts. On Friday a sudden loss of electricity left SSP with worryingly low reserves.

Katy Perry, a pop star, rebuked the Trump administration after her hit song, "Firework", was used in a TikTok video showing military strikes on Iranian targets. "I did not approve this, I was not asked and I absolutely do not condone it," the singer said in a statement. "My music is for bringing people together, not celebrating warfare." Numerous artists have criticised the White House for unauthorised use of their music in videos on social media.

Markets face the summer heat



Photograph: AFP via Getty Images

Financial markets tend to be jittery in the summer, something [often attributed](#) to inexperienced traders running desks while their bosses laze on a beach. But this week brings even more potential for volatility than usual. The renewed oil-price squeeze, caused by the Strait of Hormuz remaining closed and the Houthis' threats to ships in the Red Sea, has pushed a barrel of Brent crude close to (and briefly above) \$100. The recent pause in fighting has pushed down oil prices, but unless tensions permanently recede—or there is serious demand destruction—crude could still surpass \$120 a barrel by the end of summer.

Big tech's quarterly earnings may shake nerves too. Microsoft and Meta report on Wednesday; Amazon and Apple on Thursday. Investors are anxious about the size of their capital expenditure, and want reassurance that AI bets will pay off. The Federal Reserve also announces its interest-rate decision on Wednesday. Policymakers will probably hold rates, but may hint at further rises if inflation does not ease. After all that, investors may need a holiday.

America prepares to deport Haitian immigrants



Photograph: Getty Images

Some 330,000 Haitians in America will lose Temporary Protected Status on Monday—a designation that lets migrants from countries that the government deems unsafe stay. Haitians were granted TPS after an earthquake in 2010. It has been extended several times as gangs have ravaged Haiti. But in June [America's Supreme Court](#) cleared the way for the Trump administration to end it. The government says it will begin deporting 250 Haitians to Cap Haitien, a gang-free city in the north, each week.

The revocation comes as [violence in Haiti](#) spikes. Earlier this month at least 61 people were killed in a massacre, including 14 children. A recent UN report said that armed gangs were seeking to “capture the systems of governance”. America’s government insists that Haitians no longer need protection, but this month the State Department reissued its grim advice for Americans travelling to Haiti: draft a will and “leave DNA samples” with their medical providers, in case their remains need to be identified.

In with the New in Turkey

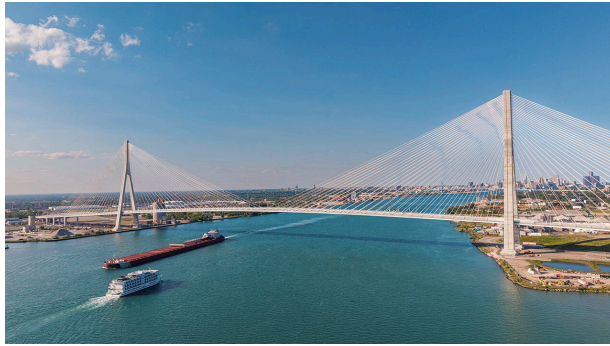


Photograph: Getty Images

For nearly a quarter century, the Republican People's Party (CHP) was Turkey's main opposition. That changed in the blink of an eye on Friday, when Ozgur Ozel, the CHP's recently deposed leader, and his supporters announced the creation of the unimaginatively named New Party (YP). More than 90 CHP parliamentarians have already defected to the YP, making it the biggest opposition party in parliament.

But the YP faces a gauntlet of obstacles before it can mount a serious challenge to Turkey's president, Recep Tayyip Erdogan, and his ruling Justice and Development party. Elections are expected as early as next year; to contest them, the YP will need to organise in at least half of Turkey's 81 provinces and hold a national congress at least six months before. Most importantly, it will need to survive government lawfare. The CHP's presidential candidate, Ekrem Imamoglu, is in prison on trumped-up charges. YP officials may be next in line.

A bridge too far



Photograph: Reuters

On Monday a bridge connecting Michigan and Canada will finally open to traffic. At least, Canadians think it will. The 2.5km span has become a pawn in Donald Trump's trade game, and the ribbon-cutting has already been delayed once.

The Gordie Howe bridge, named for a Canadian hockey player who played for the Detroit Red Wings, was conceived in 2012, when Barack Obama was president and Canada and America had a happy relationship. Since then, Mr Trump decided Canada was taking advantage of its powerful neighbour and imposed a series of tariffs on Canadian exports. The opening date was pushed back, then suddenly rescheduled.

The new bridge will ease congestion and speed up cross-border trade. But such arguments do not always work on the petty Mr Trump, who announced new tariffs on Canada last week. On Friday he declared the bridge deal "dead". Canadians will hope he used the weekend to cool off.

Reasons for concern and hope in the fight against AIDS



Photograph: AFP via Getty Images

The 26th International AIDS Conference opens on Monday in Rio de Janeiro. Two things will dominate the meeting of experts, activists and patients. One is how to respond to Donald Trump's America First Global Health Strategy, which will shift more of the burden of fighting the disease from American taxpayers to those in poor countries. The other is the roll-out of Lenacapavir, a drug which, if taken twice-yearly by injection, prevents infection by HIV, the AIDS-causing virus.

HIV-related deaths have fallen from 2m two decades ago to 570,000 last year. America's new approach puts that progress at risk. American support for AIDS programmes in South Africa has ended, and several other places, including Ghana, Zambia and Zimbabwe, are balking at the terms on offer. On the plus side, PEPFAR, America's anti-AIDS agency, which despite presidential hostility has support in Congress, is leading an effort to make Lenacapavir available to 3m people by 2028.

Daily quiz



Illustration: Sandra Navarro

We will serve you a new question each weekday. On Friday your challenge is to give us all five answers and tell us the theme. Email your responses (and your home city and country) by 1700 BST on Friday to [\[email protected\]](#). We'll pick three winners at random and crown them on Saturday.

Monday: What sportsman's first names are actually Eldrick Tont?

*Dream is not that which you see
while sleeping it is something that
does not let you sleep.*

A.P.J. Abdul Kalam